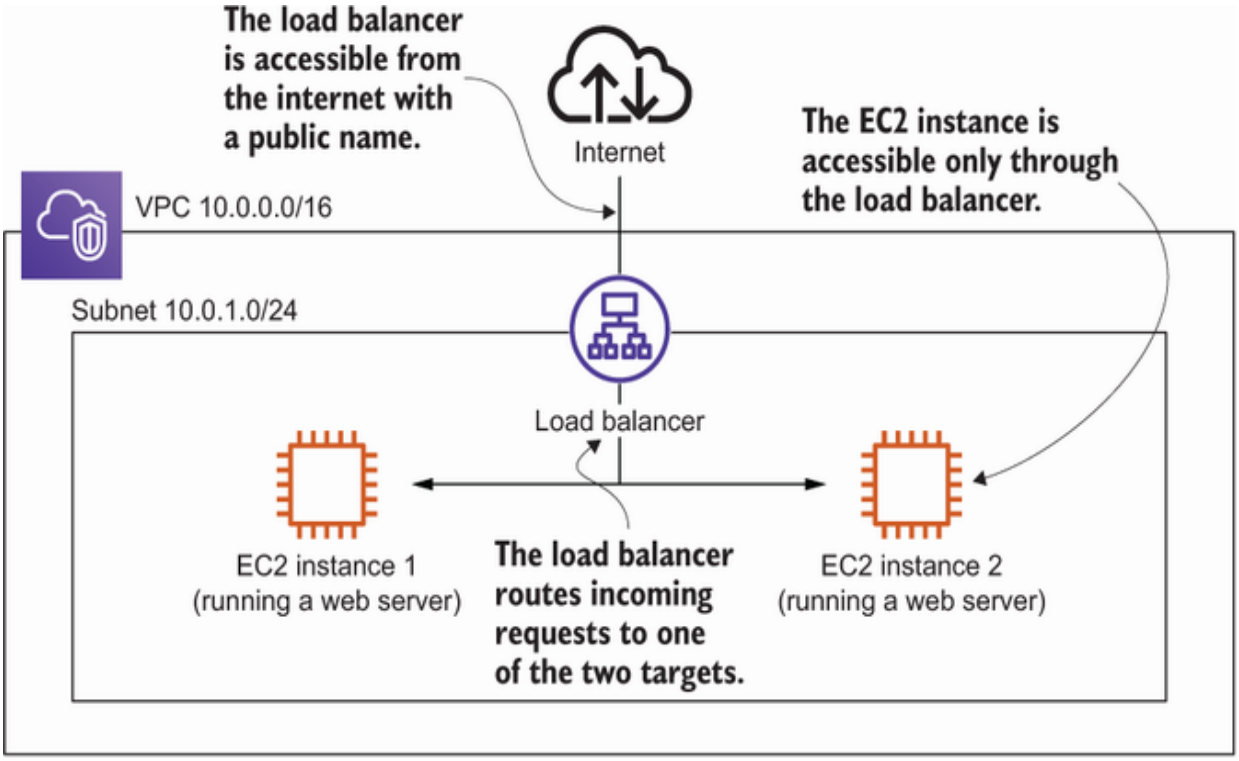


Figure 14.1 A load balancer synchronously decouples your EC2 instances.

The requester (such as a web browser) sends an HTTP request to the load balancer. The load balancer then selects one of the EC2 instances and copies the original HTTP request to send to the EC2 instance that it selected. The EC2 instance then processes the request and sends a response. The load balancer receives the response and sends the same response to the original requester.

AWS offers different types of load balancers through the Elastic Load Balancing (ELB) service. All load balancer types are fault tolerant and scalable. They differ in supported protocols and features as follows:

- *Application Load Balancer (ALB)*—HTTP, HTTPS
- *Network Load Balancer (NLB)*—TCP, TCP TLS